

Family Cotingidae

## Cotingas

Length  $3\frac{1}{2}$ –18 in (9–45 cm)

Species 66



Cotingas vary widely in appearance. They include the 2 bright orange cock-of-the-rock species, brilliant blue cotingas, umbrellabirds with their umbrella-like crests, and the bellbirds with their wattles. Most are found in lowland forest, but some occur in mountain forest and shrubbery in the Andes. All cotingas

are fruit-eaters, and some also feed on insects. Males of some species display at a lek to attract females. Some species build a tiny platform nest and lay only one egg, which takes 23–28 days to hatch.



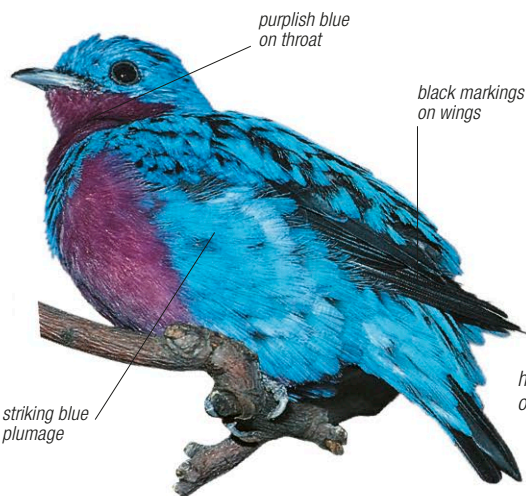
## THREE-WATTLED BELLBIRD

The male of the species *Procnias tricarunculatus* has one of the loudest bird calls, a deafening "bock" that rings over the forest canopy. This Central American bird is 10–12 in (25–30 cm) long. Its bill opens wide enough to swallow large fruit whole.



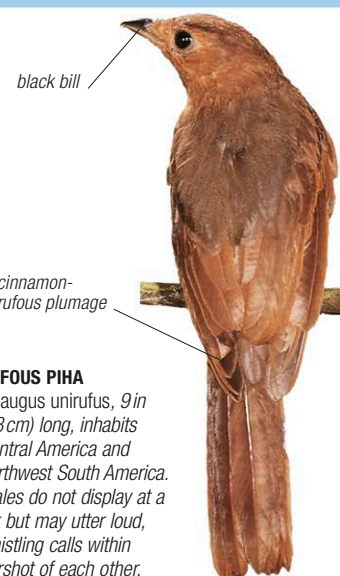
## ANDEAN COCK-OF-THE-ROCK

During courtship, the males of this species, *Rupicola peruvianus*, confront each other aggressively at a lek, the display becoming frantic when females appear. This bird is 12 in (30 cm) long, and as its name suggests, is found in the Andes.



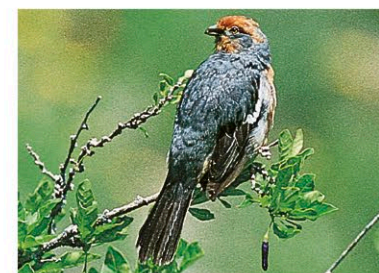
## AMAZONIAN UMBRELABIRD

Found along the Amazon and Orinoco rivers, and in east Andean forest, *Cephalopterus ornatus* is 16–19½ in (41–49 cm) long. While courting, males expand their crest and their enlarged wattle as they utter a deep, moaning "boom." Females are smaller.



## RUFIOUS PIHA

*Lipaugus unirufus*, 9 in (23 cm) long, inhabits Central America and northwest South America. Males do not display at a lek but may utter loud, whistling calls within earshot of each other.



## WHITE-TIPPED PLANTCUTTER

*Phytotoma rutila*, 7½ in (19 cm) in length, is found in the dry scrub and acacia groves of Bolivia, Paraguay, Uruguay, and Argentina. This short-crested bird has a mechanical-sounding call.

## LOVELY COTINGA

*Cotinga amabilis*, 8 in (20 cm) long, is found in high forest canopies of Central America. The male's outer wing feathers make a tinkling noise during courtship. The female may destroy the nest after her young have flown, to prevent predators from finding the site, which is often reused.

Family Tityridae

## Tityras and becards

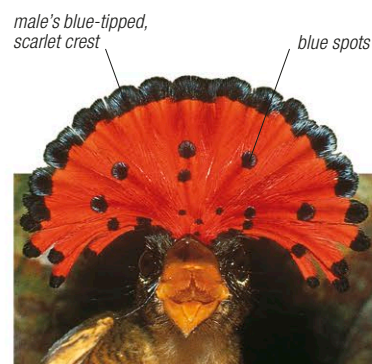
Length (3½ in) 9 cm

Species 45



The tityras of Central and South America are small birds of forest-edge habitats, living around clearings and rough, open plantations or in bushy vegetation. They live in pairs or family groups, perching quite conspicuously, and are consequently much easier to see than typical deep-forest species. Becards are found in similarly open habitats, but some species live in the canopy of denser forest, where they are difficult to observe. One species, the rose-throated becard, is found north as far as the southern USA and another lives in Jamaica. Tityras make a nest of dry leaves in a tree cavity such as a woodpecker hole, while becards build

a domed nest of dead leaves, mosses, and roots, with an entrance at the bottom, usually in the outer branches of a tree. Tityras are strikingly patterned, with adult males largely black and white, while becards have a greater variety of boldly patterned or subtly colored plumages, with more cryptically colored females.

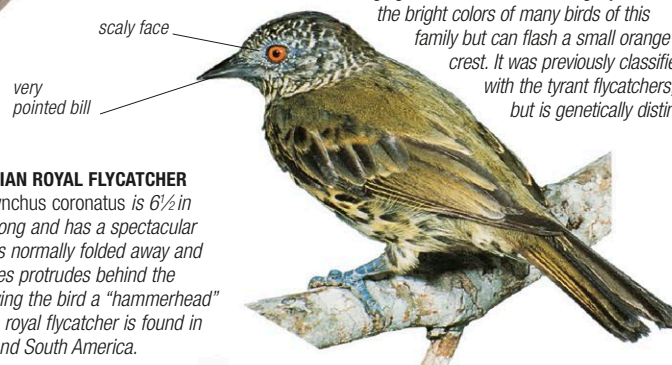


## BARRED BECARD

A bird of the middle layer or high canopy of forests, *Pachyrhamphus versicolor* picks insects and spiders from leaves, often hovering to take prey or pick berries. It feeds singly or in pairs, or in mixed flocks moving through the forest.

## SHARPBILL

The aptly-named Sharpbill (*Oxyruncus cristatus*)—ranging from Costa Rica to Paraguay—lacks the bright colors of many birds of this family but can flash a small orange crest. It was previously classified with the tyrant flycatchers, but is genetically distinct.



## AMAZONIAN ROYAL FLYCATCHER

*Onychorhynchus coronatus* is 6½ in (16 cm) long and has a spectacular crest. It is normally folded away and sometimes protrudes behind the head, giving the bird a "hammerhead" look. The royal flycatcher is found in Central and South America.